BODY—BACKGLASS/LIFTGATE—XENOY MATERIAL BACKGLASS AVAILABLE TO SERVICE CRACKS, WARPAGE, SEPARATION—SERVICE TIPS

Article No. 02-25-6

FORD: 2002 EXPLORER

MERCURY: 2002 MOUNTAINEER

ISSUE

Some 4 Door Explorer/Mountaineer vehicles may exhibit cracking, warpage or separation of the rear liftgate applique (exterior trim panel below the backglass). This may be caused by the adhesive bond strength of the original part. Highly concentrated washer fluid (not properly diluted) can also act as a trigger to induce this condition.

ACTION

Replace the backglass assembly with revised part number which contains a new "Xenoy" applique material. Refer to the following Service Procedure for details.

SERVICE PROCEDURE

NOTE

THE APPLIQUE IS NOT SERVICEABLE SEPARATE FROM THE BACKGLASS AND IS SUPPLIED IN PRIME FINISH ONLY. IT WILL BE NECESSARY TO PAINT TO MATCH.

NOTE

IF LIFTGATE SHEETMETAL REPLACEMENT IS NECESSARY FOR ANY REASON ON AN EARLY BUILD VEHICLE, CURRENTLY THE BACKGLASS AND SUPPORTS MUST BE UPDATED TO LATER BUILD STYLE (FIGURE 4). TO IDENTIFY BY BUILD DATE, SEE STEP 2 IN SERVICE PROCEDURE. PLANNED FOR 1ST PART OF 2003, THE EARLY BUILD LIFTGATE STYLE WILL AGAIN BECOME AVAILABLE SO THIS WILL NOT BE NECESSARY.

1. This is the area above the license plate and below the rear glass, by the Ford or Mercury emblem. Typical failures include vertical crack (Figure 1), horizontal crack (Figure 2), and warpage or separation (Figure 3).
2. Check the VIN number to determine if the 11th digit is a "U" or a "Z".
   a. Louisville Plant Built - 11th VIN digit "U":
      - If vehicle build date prior to 3/4/02, order 2002/J1 backglass (1L2Z)
      - If vehicle build date 3/4/02 or later, order 2002.5/J2 backglass (3L2Z)
   b. St. Louis Plant built - 11th VIN digit "Z":
      - If vehicle build date prior to 3/11/02, order 2002/J1 backglass (1L2Z)
      - If vehicle build date 3/11/02 or later, order 2002.5/J2 backglass (3L2Z)

NOTE

AS AN ADDITIONAL IDENTIFIER, 2002/JOB 1 VEHICLES ARE BUILT WITH LIFTGATE SUPPORTS MOUNTED TO A BRACKET THAT IS FASTENED HIGH UP ON THE GLASS. IN CONTRAST THE 2002.5/JOB 2 MOUNTING DESIGN ATTACHES THE SUPPORT ARMS ONTO BALL STUDS AT A LOWER MOUNTING POINT ON THE GLASS (FIGURE 4).

3. Reference the 2002 Explorer/Mountaineer Workshop Manual, Section 501-11 for backglass removal and installation procedures.

NOTE

INSPECT THE PRIMED APPLIQUE FINISH ON EITHER SIDE OF THE MIDDLE EMBLEM AREA FOR A VERY SLIGHTLY DIMPLED CONDITION. IF PRESENT, LIGHTLY SAND WITH 320 GRIT SAND PAPER BEFORE CONTINUING SERVICE.

4. Wipe the backglass with wax and grease remover. Scuff the moulding (applique) with a red Scotchbrite pad.
5. Blow off the backglass with compressed air to remove loose dust and debris.
6. Mask off the applique using 3M "L" shaped tape to get under the glass. Continue masking as necessary.

NOTE: The information in Technical Service Bulletins is intended for use by trained, professional technicians with the knowledge, tools, and equipment to do the job properly and safely. It informs these technicians of conditions that may occur on some vehicles, or provides information that could assist in proper vehicle service. The procedures should not be performed by "do-it-yourselfers". Do not assume that a condition described affects your car or truck. Contact a Ford, Lincoln, or Mercury dealership to determine whether the Bulletin applies to your vehicle.

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7. Mix and apply (1.5 mils minimum) of primer-surfacer, following the manufacturer's label recommendations and bake at 140° F panel temperature per manufacturer's recommended baking time.
8. Sand the repair area with 400-600 grit sandpaper.
9. Blow off the area with compressed air to remove loose dust and debris.
10. Wipe the backglass with a wax and grease remover. Wipe dry using a clean, lint-free cloth to remove all residue.

NOTE
KEEP WIPING UNTIL THE SURFACE IS COMPLETELY DRY. ANY RESIDUE MAY RESULT IN CONTAMINATION OF THE COATINGS TO BE APPLIED FOLLOWING THIS STEP.

11. Mix and apply Ford-approved basecoat material to hiding over the entire panel, following the manufacturer's label recommendations and flash time.
12. Mix and apply 2.0 mils Ford-approved clearcoat to the entire panel. Let flash, booth purge, and bake at 140° F panel temperature following manufacturer's recommended baking time.
13. Demask the part, and install the backglass assembly onto the vehicle.

PART NUMBER	PART NAME
1L2Z-78422A12-AB	Backglass - Explorer - Privacy - Built Before 3/4/2002
1L2Z-78422A12-BB	Backglass - Explorer - Solar- Built Before 3/4/2002
1L2Z-78422A12-CB	Backglass - Mountaineer - Privacy - Built Before 3/4/2002
1L2Z-78422A12-DB	Backglass - Mountaineer - Solar - Built Before 3/4/2002
3L2Z-78422A12-AB	Backglass - Explorer - Privacy - Built On Or After 3/4/2002
3L2Z-78422A12-BA	Backglass - Explorer - Solar - Built On Or After 3/4/2002
3L2Z-78422A12-CB	Backglass - Mountaineer - Privacy - Built On Or After 3/4/2002
3L2Z-78422A12-DA	Backglass - Mountaineer - Solar - Built On Or After 3/4/2002

(Cont'd.)

OTHER APPLICABLE ARTICLES: NONE
WARRANTY STATUS: Eligible Under The Provisions Of Bumper To Bumper Warranty Coverage

OPERATION	DESCRIPTION	TIME
022506A	Replace Liftgate Window Glass	0.7 Hr.
022506B	Additional Time To Paint For Operation A	1.2 Hrs.
022506P101	Basic Paint Labor Operation - Can Be Claimed Once Per Visit	0.5 Hr.

DEALER CODING

BASIC PART NO.	CONDITION CODE
78422A12	01

OASIS CODES: 102000, 106000, 108000, 111000

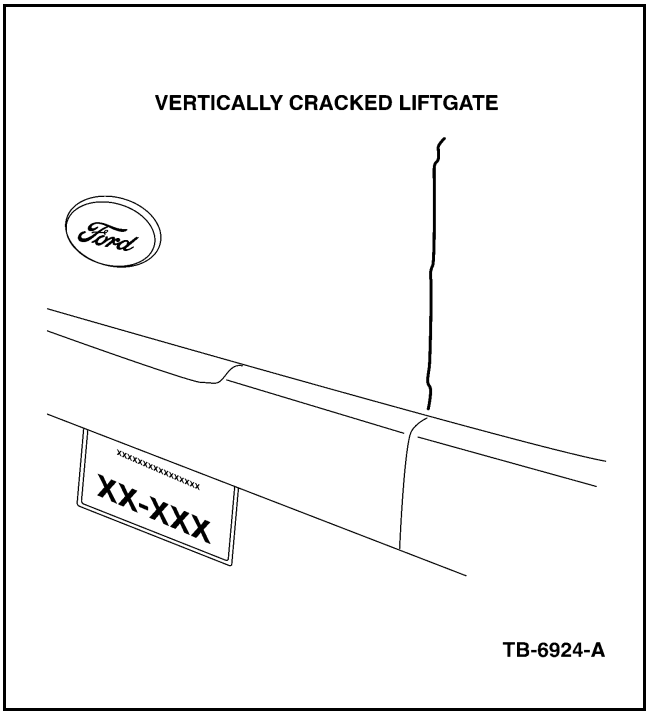


Figure 1 - Article 02-25-6

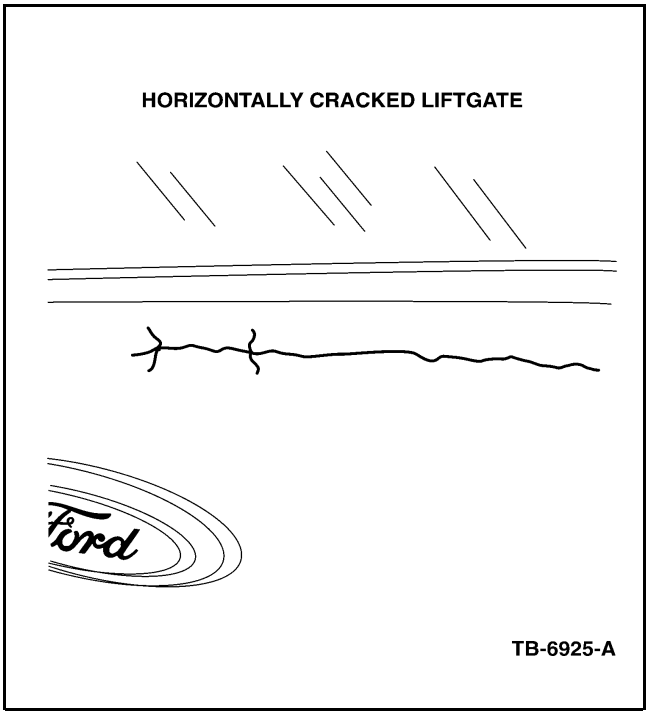


Figure 2 - Article 02-25-6

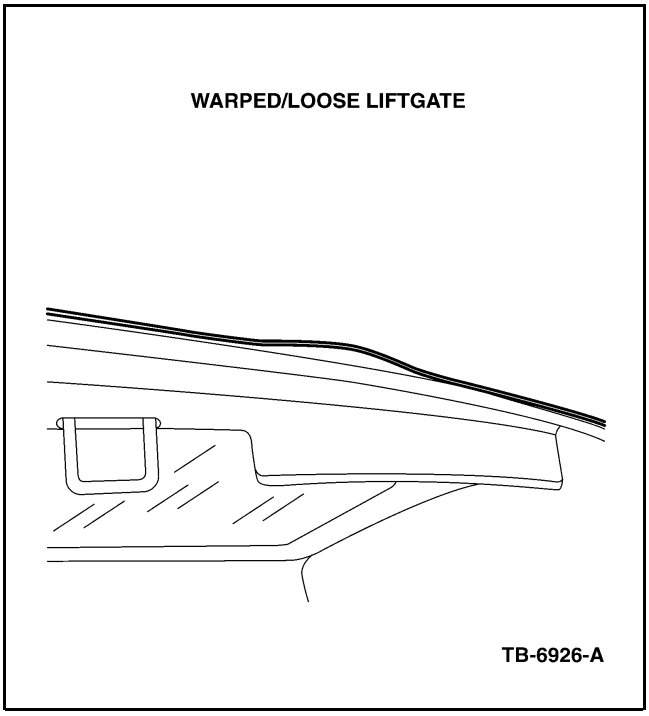


Figure 3 - Article 02-25-6

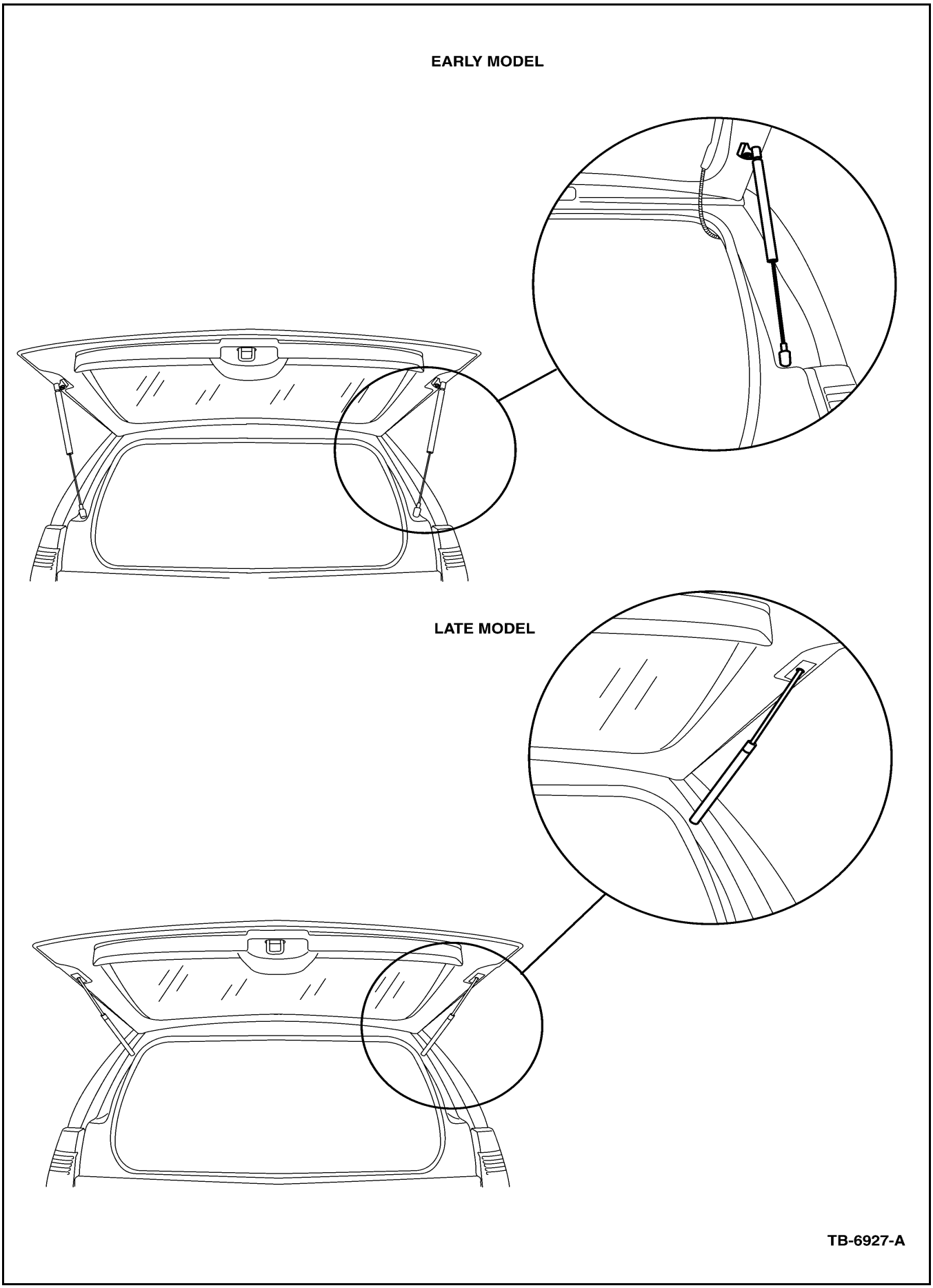


Figure 4 - Article 02-25-6